

D-Link DSL-2640T Wireless G ADSL2+ Router

Decent for a small network

The D-Link DSL-2640T is a three-in-one device—an ADSL modem, a 4-port router, and a wireless access point all packaged in stylish silver-grey plastic.

The D-Link DSL-2640T is just what you need if you have more than one computer and need to share your ADSL broadband connection. It is ADSL2/2+ compliant, and is therefore capable of theoretical download speeds up to 24 Mbps. 802.11 b/g wireless capability allows it to transmit data at up to 54 Mbps. The 4-port fast Ethernet switch lets you connect four computers to it, and you can also add a few laptops to your home network using the integrated Wi-Fi access point.

You can set up the DSL-2640T in a jiffy. The easy-to-understand browser

interface has a Wizard that puts you in the driver's seat and lets you configure the router the way you want. Security has not been neglected either, with support for enhanced wireless security using WPA and WPA2. The integrated firewall with NAT, SPI, and DoS capabilities further strengthen the safety of your PC from hackers. You can even block out offensive URLs or complete domains.

Though we could not test the ADSL performance, we tested the Wi-Fi capabilities of the device. Scores were average compared to the other two ADSL routers we tested earlier this year. It could transfer sequential files at a rate of 1.22 MBps in the closest zone, while it managed 0.55 in the farthest zone, putting it a shade

ahead of the ASUS WL-600G but a step behind the Netgear DG834G as far as overall performance is concerned.

D-Link has provided an ADSL splitter so you can connect the telephone line to the router and still not miss a call. The accompanying CD contains a manual and a Wizard that are good enough to ease any of your worries about installing the device. In sum, this is a decent ADSL router for



setting up a small office or home network.

Specifications

ADSL/ADSL2 compliant; Ports: 1 x ADSL RJ-11 for 24/26 AWG twisted pair telephone wire, 4 x 10/100 LAN RJ-45; Wi-Fi standard: 802.11b/g

Contact: D-Link India Ltd
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E-mail: sales@dlink.co.in
Web site: www.dlink.co.in
Price: Rs 4,300 (plus taxes)

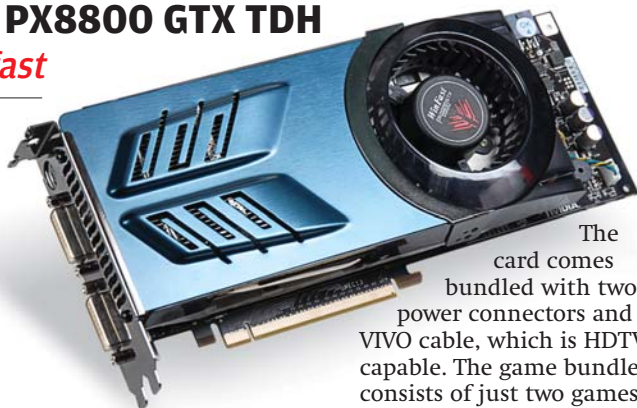
RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Ease of Use	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Leadtek WinFast PX8800 GTX TDH

Fast, and we mean fast

Keeping up with its regular production cycle, NVIDIA has added one more powerful performer to its roster—the GeForce 8800 GTX. Manufacturer Leadtek was one of the first to secure it, launching the WinFast 8800 GTX. A full DirectX 10 part, this promises unprecedented performance under Vista.

Leadtek has built the card using NVIDIA's reference design. The heatsink does a pretty good job at cooling, and is not noisy. The card is long, and we mean long: its 10.5-inches exceeded the width of our D945XB2 motherboard by over an inch! Not many cabinets will accommodate this card. It requires two Molex power connectors, so you should make sure you have an appropriate power supply. There are two SLI connectors on the card,



which essentially double the SLI bandwidth for to-and-fro data transfer.

The G80GTX core features the Unified Shader Architecture, which has the capability of doing physics computations on the chip, so the CPU is not much of a bottleneck. There is 768 MB of 384-bit wide GDDR3 memory at 900 MHz, yielding a (huge!) bandwidth of 84.4 GB/s. This is more than enough for any game out there, with enough headroom for future games.

The card comes bundled with two power connectors and a VIVO cable, which is HDTV-capable. The game bundle consists of just two games—*SpellForce 2* and *TrackMania Nations*.

The card delivers what it promises, gauging from our test results. The performance difference between this card and that of its lesser siblings was not much at the lower, CPU-limited resolutions, but as we went up, cranking up

the sliders, this was the only card that held its own against the barrage of our benchmarks. It scored 10879 in 3DMark06, and did 83 fps in F.E.A.R. at 1600 x 1200 in its full glory. Though a shade slower than the stock NVIDIA 8800GTX, this is still one of the fastest cards out there, and with exceptionally good image quality.

Price at Rs 33,000, the card offers relatively good value for money. DX10 is not yet out, so we'll have to wait to look at the card's DX10 performance.

Specifications

GPU: NVIDIA GeForce 8800 GTX; memory: 384-bit 768 MB GDDR3 @ 900 MHz (effective: 1800 MHz); GPU clock (Geometric): 576 MHz; GPU clock (Shader): 1350 MHz; memory bandwidth: 84.4 GB/s

Contact: TopNotch Infotronics
Phone: 9323546190
E-mail: mushtaq@zebronics.info
Web site: www.leadtek.com
Price: Rs 33,000

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Image Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆